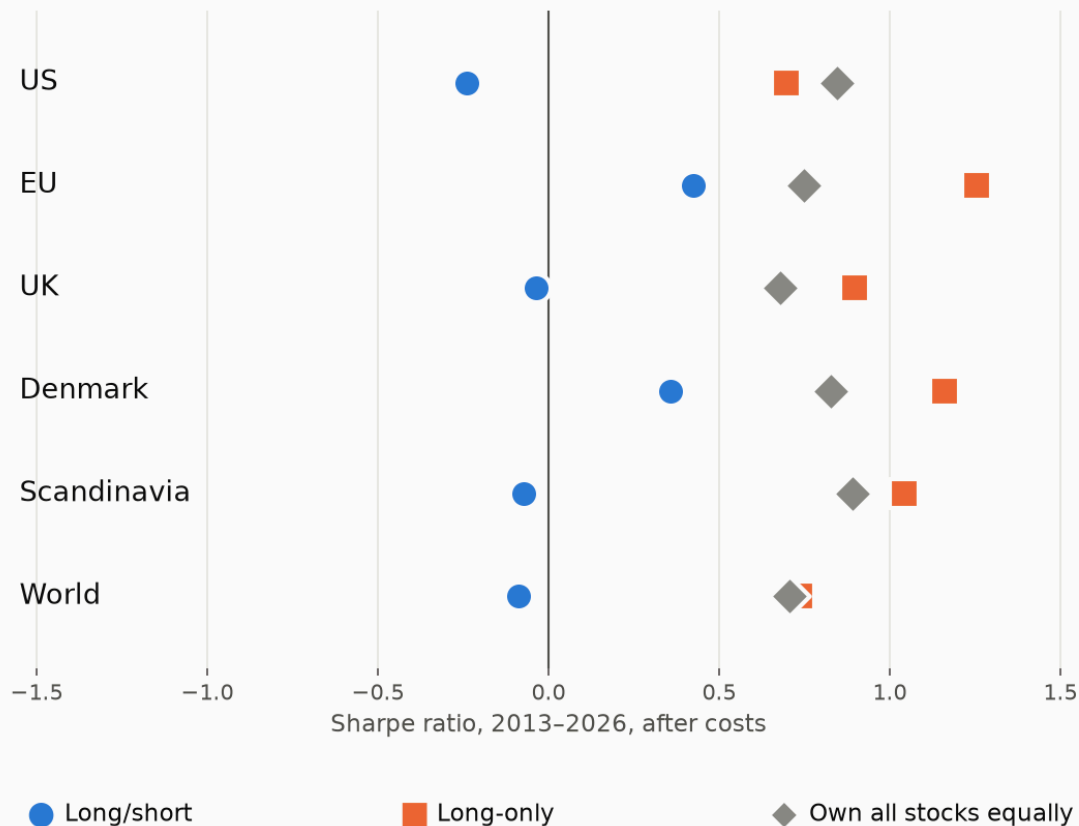


# 52-week high

Do stocks near their high keep going?



**Long/short positive in 2 of six markets; long-only beat owning all stocks in 5 of six.**

Henrik Gjernerig · Project 10 · point-in-time universes, local currency (World in USD)

Henrik Gjernerig · LinkedIn

Stocks trading close to their 52-week high outperform those far below it, and this nearness explains much of momentum. George & Hwang (2004) found it for US stocks 1963–2001; investors anchor on the high and under-react to good news near it.

I tested it on six markets, 2013–2026: US, Europe, UK, Denmark, Scandinavia and the world. Point-in-time index members, after costs.

Long/short (stocks closest to their 52-week high minus stocks furthest below it): -5.8% to +8.8% a year, positive in 2 of six markets. Adjusted for market beta: +6.3% to +18.6%.

Long-only (stocks closest to their 52-week high): a better Sharpe than owning all the stocks equally in 5 of six markets.

The pre-declared fixes (beta-neutral legs, a turnover buffer, volatility targeting) took the 2020–26 holdout Sharpe from 0.04 to 0.52.

360° view: it keeps some information beyond its nearest neighbours.

Full factsheet with P&L, trade records, drawdowns, factor attribution, fixes, classification and the 360° view: <https://hgjernerling.github.io/now-showing/factsheets/fs09-52-week-high>

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